regions, primarily in Asia. These are complemented by the smothering of domestic liberal trends and prevention of the further growth of civil society inside China, all to forestall any domestic liberalization, such as threatened the CCP in 1989. These rules threaten to poison relations between China and the wider world, leading to further trade wars, propaganda battles, and possibly even military clashes. If unchecked, the effects on the global economy and peace in Asia could be truly destabilizing.

The new rules begin with bolstering China's economy by any means. Focused on investment profits and cheaper consumer goods, Western nations long ignored the ways in which China undercut domestic producers around the world, leading to the exodus of manufacturing jobs from advanced countries. Its mercantilist policies led it to conquer sectors like textiles or solar panels, and drive out all competition from the marketplace. By some estimates, up to 3.4 million American jobs were lost due to Chinese competition between 2001, when China entered the World Trade Organization, and 2015.[26] Observers long credited low wages paid to Chinese workers, state subsidies, and outright dumping as leading ways in which Chinese companies outmaneuvered Western competitors.

Only in recent years, however, has attention been focused on the scale and scope of China's technological and industrial espionage as an element in its economic growth. For decades, the world was willing to turn a blind eye to Chinese theft of intellectual property, all in the hopes of gaining access to the country's vast market. Yet untold billions, probably trillions, of dollars of proprietary information has been pilfered by Chinese hackers and more traditional spies. The US-based Commission on the Theft of American Intellectual Property estimates the annual cost to the US economy of IP theft could be as high as $600 billion and not less than $200 billion.[27] The US Office of the Director of National Intelligence has calculated the cost of economic espionage by hacking to be $400 billion a year.[28] By far the majority of that stealing is done by China, much of it directed by the PLA, which has developed dedicated cyber espionage units, such as Unit 61398,